

HR Mock Interview

September 14, 2026 - 05:23 PM ET

Transcript

[04:56 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Hi! I'm your AI interviewer for the HR Mock Interview. This is a required interview for your career curriculum, and I'll ask you a set of questions one at a time. Take your time. Are you ready to begin?

[04:57 PM ET] You: Yes.

[04:57 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Wonderful. Let's get started.

What accomplishment are you most proud of in your career so far, and why?

[04:58 PM ET] You: Uh, during my Q&A, uh, training, one of my biggest projects was, uh, uh, Orban Scooter project, where I had to test web, mobile, and, um, API functions. My task was I needed to understand the requirements, create and execute test cases, uh, identify and document defects, and complete the different areas of testing within the project. Um, I had to break down the project into smaller tasks, review the requirements carefully, create positive and negative test cases. Uh, uh, the testweb application, and use the API to create, uh, a carrier, a courier account, so I could continue testing the mobile application. Um, for the result, I completed the project, gained hands-on experience across the web and mobile and API testing. I'm most proud of it because it showed me that I can work through challenges for Q&A projects, solving problems step by step, and keeping, and keep on learning when I don't immediately know the answer.

[04:58 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. What was one of the more challenging problems you ran into during that project, and how did you work through it?

[04:58 PM ET] You: ...

[04:58 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Take your time. Would you like me to repeat the question?

[04:59 PM ET] You: No. No, thank you. Um, during my Uber Orbn scooter project, one of my challenges parts was testing the mobile application because I couldn't log in without the first creating, uh, the carrier account through the, uh, API. Uh, I, I needed to figure out how to create it, uh, account, uh, the carrier account correctly so I could access the mobile app and continue testing. Um, I went back to the project requirements for the API documentation, identify the correct endpoint, working through the impa- IP- API request step bystep, creating the carrier act- account, and use the credentials to log into the mobile application. Um, the result, I was able to unblock myself to continue the requirement mobile test. Uh, I, I taught, it taught me that when I run into a problem, I can use the available documentations to break the problem into smaller steps and troubleshooting it instead of getting stuck.

[04:59 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Got it. Let's move on.

What factors are most important to you when considering your next role?

[05:00 PM ET] You: I am the beg- I am at the beginning of the Q&A career, so I'm looking for a role where I can continue building real-world experiences. Uh, my goal is to find a position where I can contri- contribute to the product quality while continuing to develop my Q&A skills. Uh, the most important thing is to look for, uh, opportunities to work with a supportive team, collaborate with developers and other team members, um, getting

hands-on testing experience, and continue learning areas like API autom- automation tes- testing. I'm looking for a role where I can contribute from beginning, but also grow into the stronger and more technical Q&A over time.

[05:00 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. Can you tell me about a specific moment when you felt that kind of collaborative environment made a real difference for you?

[05:01 PM ET] You: Um, during my Q&A training, I worked with people I didn't know very well, and we sometimes had different ways of understanding the requirements or approaching a problem. Uh, I needed to make sure to understand their ideas while also communicating my own questions and concerns clearly so we can keep moving forward. Um, I asked questions, listened to their feedback, um, sharing what I was seeing in my testing. I wa- als- and, and I also focused on solving the problem rather than proving that one person was right or wrong. Other communication made it easier to work through questions and complete, uh, the work. It showed me that I can learn and solve problems better when people fall, feel comfortable asking questions, sharing ideas, and helping each other.

[05:01 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Okay, let's move on.

How do you ensure everyone stays aligned during a project?

[05:02 PM ET] You: Um, during my Orban scooter project, I added several areas to keep track of, including web, mobile, and API testing. Uh, I needed to make sure the work stayed in line with my project requirements and the important tasks, testing, errors weren't missing. I used requirements, the main reference, reference, kept my test cases and results organized. Um, I documented, uh, what I had been completed and what still needed, uh, needed attention on. Uh, if something was unclear, I would definitely clarify it instead of making assumptions. And in a team environment, I would also communicate progress, blockers, and changes so everyone has the same information as I do. Uh, this helped me stay organized and helped me test focus on the requirements. Also taught me that alignment comes from clear communication, good documentation, and addressing questions earlier before they become bigger problems.

[05:02 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. Can you walk me through a specific time you had to communicate a blocker or a change to someone else, and what happened as a result?

[05:03 PM ET] You: During my Orbin School project, I reached the mobile testing portion. And realized I couldn't continue because I needed a, a carry account through the API before I could log in. Uh, I needed to communicate that dependently, clearly, and figure out what had to be completed before I continue the mobile testing. I explained where I, where I was blocked and what I, what I understood from the requirements. Then I reviewed the, uh, API documentation, identified the correct endpoint, created a carry account, and used the credentials to log into mobile application. The block, uh, blocker was resolved, and I was able to continue, comp- complete therequired mobile test scenarios and taught me that communicating a block earlier while also investigating solution can, um, definitely prevent unne- unnecessary delays.

[05:03 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Got it. Let's move on.

Have you ever had to deliver difficult feedback? How did you approach it?

[05:05 PM ET] You: Um, during a Q&A training, I found issues where the actual result didn't match the expected result. Reporting a defect can be form of difficult feedback because you are pointing out that something isn't working as expected. Uh, I needed to communicate the problem clearly without making it any personal, personal or blaming anyone. I found the focus on facts, documenting the steps re- reproduced the defect, test data, expected result, and actual result, and including supporting evidence when needed. I kept my communication focused on the product and the issue rather than who have made... who had ofcaused the problem. The defect was documented

clear enough for someone to review it to understand that re- to reproduce the problem. It taught me that difficult feedback is most effective when it's respectfully specific and, uh, based on evidence.

[05:05 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. Can you walk me through one specific defect you reported, what the issue was, and how the person receiving it responded?

[05:06 PM ET] You: During my UBS Uber training project, I found an issue where the actual behavior of a feature didn't match the expected result and the requirements. Uh, my responsibility was to document the effect clearly enough that someone reviewing it could understand what happened and re- reproduce it. I reproduced the issue, documented e- the e- exact steps, uh, including test data, um, as clear as day, separated the expected result from the actual result, focused on the behavior of the application rather than blaming anyone. Uh, because it was a training project, I didn't work directly with a developer who responded to or fixed the specific defect. So the result for me was learning how to create and clear a reproducible- uh, uh, reproduce defect report. In a professional environment, I would be also communicating with the developer any questions and retesting the fix once it's available.

[05:06 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Okay, let's move on.

What is something you've learned recently that has improved your performance?

[05:07 PM ET] You: Um, recently through my Q&A mock interviews, I received feedback that I understood the technical concepts, but my answers needed to be more structured and, uh, included clear outcomes. Um, I wanted to improve how I could communicate with Q&A knowledge so my answers are easier to understand and more confident. Uh, I started using the STAR method, situation, task, action, end result, to organize my answers. I also have been practicing pausing instead of filling, using filler words for focusing on key points rather than memorizing entire answers. It has helped me organize my thoughts better and explain my experience more clearly. I've learned that having the technical knowledge is important, but communication of the knowledge is clear as, just as important.

[05:07 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Got it. What is a professional skill you're currently focused on developing?

[05:07 PM ET] You: I'm-

[05:07 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Take your time.

[05:08 PM ET] You: As I continue developing Q&A skills, I've become comfortable with manual testing, writing test cases, reporting defects, and basic API testing. Um, the next skill is focused on, on developing test automation so I can expand beyond manual testing. I'm working on strengthening my programming fundamentals and learning how automated tests... test cases are created and used alongside manual testing. Also want to continue improving my API testing skills before they will help me become more of a well-rounded Q&A engineer. My goal is to be able to contribute to both manual and automated testings, and eventually take on more of the technical Q&A responsibilities as I gain experience.

[05:08 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. Can you walk me through something specific you've done recently to work toward that automation goal?

[05:08 PM ET] You: ...

[05:08 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Take your time. Would you like me to repeat the question?

[05:08 PM ET] You: Yes, if you don't mind.

[05:08 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Of course. Can you walk me through something specific you've done recently to work toward your automation goal?

[05:08 PM ET] You: ...

[05:08 PM ET] AI Interviewer: No rush. Would you like a moment to gather your thoughts?

[05:08 PM ET] You: Yes, please.

[05:08 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Take all the time you need.

[05:09 PM ET] You: Um, I recently realized that automating, mo- automutation is an area w- I want to grow in s- as I continue developing Q&A skills. Um, before jumping directly into automation tools, I wanted to strengthen the fundamental, the automation, depending on especially understanding the test cases, APIs, and how to design reliable test scenarios. I've been practicing creating structuring test cases, working on API requests and responses in Postman. I'm improving how I identify positive, negative, and boundary scenarios. I'm also working on building my program knowledge just so I can eventually turnsome of those manual test cases into automated test cases. I'm building a strong foundation for automation instead of just learning a tool without understanding the, the tests, testing behind it. My next goal is to start creating simple automated tests and building them from, building from there.

[05:09 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Got it. Let's move on.

How do you typically approach situations where expectations are not clearly defined?

[05:11 PM ET] You: During my Q&A, my Orban scoo- scooter pro- scooter project, there was times where the requirements or expected behavior were completely, complete- weren't completely clear to me. I needed to understand that was actually expected before continuing my tests, so I wouldn't make sure assumptions or report something un- incorrectly. I went back to the requirements of the documentation, compared them with the application, action, behavior, broke the problem into smaller parts. If something was still unclear, I would ha- ask specific questions and document what I need and what stillneeded clarification. The approach helped me make, m- me, helped me make better dec- dec- testing decisions and avoid unnecessary mistakes. It taught me that when ex- expectations aren't clear, I should, uh, clarify earl- clarify early, use the available information, and avoid making assumptions.

[05:11 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. Can you give me a specific example of a time something was unclear, what question you asked or step you took, and what the outcome was?

[05:12 PM ET] You: During my Urban Scoop project, I reached the mobile test- testing section, and the instructions said I need to create a carrier through the API before I could log in. At first, I was clear on how those parts connected. I needed to understand the dependence and figure out how to get the correct login credentials so I could continue testing. Instead of guessing, I went back to the requirements and API documentation. The question I was trying to, was trying to answer was, what do I need to create through the API so I can get into the login mobile app? I found thecarrier creation endpoint, created the account, and used the credentials in the mobile app- application. I was able to log in, unblock the mobile testing, and continue with the required test scenarios. It showed me that when something is unclear, review the doc- documentations and ask specific questions that can help you find the answers without assumptions.

[05:12 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Okay, let's move on. Tell me about a time you had to create structure in a chaotic environment.

[05:12 PM ET] You: ...

[05:12 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Take your time. Would you like me to repeat the question?

[05:13 PM ET] You: Durham, I... Durham, I... You've been scoo- scooter project, guys. Complete web, mobile, and API testing without li- a limited amount of time. At first, there were a lot of requirements, testing cases, and different tools manage- to manage the project left overwhelming. I needed to create clear instructions so I can keep track on what needed to be tested and make sure I didn't miss any important requirements. I broke the project into smaller sections, web, mobile, and API, API testing. Then I review the requirements, prioritize the most important functionality, organize my test cases, and track my expecting result.Action result and defects. I worked through each section instead of trying to handle everything at once. The structure helped me stay organized, track my progress, and complete the different parts of the project without losing focus. It taught me that when I... when a project feels chaotic, breaking into smaller priorities, making it more manageable.

[05:13 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Got it. Let's move on. Tell me about a time you held yourself accountable to a higher standard than expected.

[05:14 PM ET] You: During my, uh, my Q&A project, I was creating test cases for the customer information form. I realize I, realized that only testing the normal positive scenarios wouldn't give me enough coverage. Even though I could have focused on the basic requirement scenarios, I wanted to make sure I test how the application behave in a, in unexpected user inputs as well. I added negative and boundary test cases, including empty required fields, invalid inputs, invalid ra- uh, values around the minimum and maximum limits. Also made sure that each test case incl- had clear test datasteps, expected results, and actual results. This gave me stronger test coverage and helped me identify areas that needed close attention. More importantly, it taught me how to hold my testing to a higher standard by thinking beyond the completing the mi- minimum requirements.

[05:14 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. Can you walk me through one specific negative or boundary test case you added, what you found, and what happened as a result?

[05:15 PM ET] You: During my Q&A project, I was testing the customer information form and wanted to check what happened when a required field wa- was left empty. I needed to verify that the form wouldn't accept incomplete information, that the user would receive correct validation message. I left one of the required fields empty while entering the valid information in other fields that tried to con- continue with the order. I compared the application behavior with the expected result with the requirement and documented the actual result. That test helped me verify how the application handle- handled missing required information, gave me bettercoverage beyond the normal u- user flow. I didn't want to clair- claim it uncovered a specific defect if it didn't, if it, if it didn't document one. But if it showed me why negative testing is important for checking validation and preventing invalid data from moving forward.

[05:15 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Okay, let's move on. Tell me about a time you took responsibility for an outcome that wasn't entirely your fault.

[05:16 PM ET] You: During my Q&A project, there was times where I misunderstood a part of requirements that... or had difficulty completing a task before the instructions weren't immediately clear. Even though the difficulty wasn't entirely caused by me, it was still responsible... I was still responsible for the making sure my testing incomplete correct rather than blaming the instructions. I went back to requirements and documentation, reviewed what I had already done, where my understanding was incorrect, and corrected my work. If I still wasn't sure, I asked for clarification instead of continuing with assumptions. I was able to correct my work and continuewith the project. It taught me that even when I'm not completely responsible for what I cause a problem, I should take ownership in what I can control and focus on finding a solution.

[05:16 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. Can you walk me through one specific instance where that happened, what the misunderstanding was, and what you did to correct it?

[05:17 PM ET] You: During my, uh, Orbit Scooting project, I reached the mobile testing portion and...Initially misunderstood how I was supposed to get into the login credentials. I thought I could move directly into the testing

mobile app, but the project required me to create a Carry On account through the API first. Even though the dependence wasn't immediately clear to me, it was my responsibility to understand the requirements and get back at the mobile testing back on track. I went back to the project requirements on the API documentation instead of continuing with my assumption. I found the endpoint creating a carrier, sent the required request, created an account, and used those credentials to log into the mobile application. I corrected my inter- misunderstanding, unblocked the mobile testing, and was able to continue with the requirement test scenarios. It taught me that to oversh- ownership while, when something goes wrong, even if it's unclear instructions con- should contributed to the situation, and focus on correcting the problem rather than ass- ass- assigning the blame.

[05:17 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Got it. Let's move on. Tell me about a recommendation you made that improved efficiency or results.

[05:19 PM ET] You: During my Orbit Scooter project, I had a lot of test cases to manage across web, mobile, and API testings, and realized that testing without a clear order could waste time. I wanted to make testing process more efficient while still making sure the most important functions are covered. I recommend organizations the testing by profity, priority, and risk. I focus first on the core function and positive scenarios, then move to negative and boundary testing. I also organized my test cases around the requirements, so it was easy to see what had already been testing and what still w- on, and what was still remaining. This made my testing more organized, re- reduced the chance of repeating tests or overlooking important scenarios, and it helped me use my limited project's time more effect- effi- efficiently. It taught me that good provis- prioritization can improve both efficientary tests and coverage.

[05:19 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. Can you walk me through a specific moment where that prioritization made a noticeable difference, what you chose to test first, and what happened as a result?

[05:20 PM ET] You: Uh, during my Urban Scooter project, I had to complete web mobile API testing with limited amount of time. I realized the mobile tests, testing depending on having a carrier account created through API. I needed to decide what to do, what to work on first so I would spend time, wouldn't spend, spend time trying to test something that was still blocked. I prioritized the API dependence first, reviewed the API documentation, created the carrier account, and confirm I could use those credentials to access themobile app. Once that was working, I moved forward with the mobile test cases. The decision unblocked the mobile testing and allowed me to continue the required test scenarios without wasting time. It showed me that prioritization isn't just about what seemed most important, it's also about identifying dependencies that could affect the rest of the testing.

[05:20 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Got it. Let's move on. Tell me about a time when your first solution didn't work. What happened next?

[05:21 PM ET] You: During my CUNY project, I needed to test a mobile application, but I couldn't log in because I didn't have the carrier account. My first approach was to be... try to access the app with information I already had, but that didn't work. I needed to figure out what I was missing so I could continue testing. Instead of repeating and trying the same thing, I went back to the requirements and the API documentation. I discovered that I needed to create a carrier through API first. I found the ca- correct endpoint, created the carrier account, and used, uh, those credentials in the mobile app. The new approach worked, and I was able to log in and continue the requiredmobile testing. It taught me that this... that when we... when my first solution doesn't work, I should res- res- should reassesses the problem and use the app... available documentation and try a more inform- informed approach.

[05:21 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you. Let's move on. Tell me about a time you had to deliver results despite limited resources.

[05:22 PM ET] You: During my urban, urban scooter project, I had to complete web mobile and API testing with a limited amount of time. And with the only training tools and documentation available to me, I needed to complete the required testing while w- still providing good coverage and clear documentation. I prioritized the high risks and

important function first, organized the work into web, API, and mobile sections, reassured the requirements as my main reference, and focused on positive, negative, and boundary scenarios instead of trying to test everything at once. I was able to make steady progress in all three tests, testing, testing areas while keeping my work organized. It taught me that the resources are limited, good prioritization and organization helped me still deliver useful results without sacrificing the most important testing.

[05:22 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Got it. Last question. Describe a situation where you had to quickly reprioritize your work.

[05:23 PM ET] You: Uh, during my Q&A project, I was working through web, mobile, and API testing. I originally planned to move the web testing directly into the mobile testing. When I reached the mobile portion, I realized I couldn't continue because the app required a carrier account that had to be recreated through API. I quickly changed the priorities, moved API testing ahead of the mobile work. I reviewed the API documentation, found the carrier creation endpoint, and created the account, and when... and then returned to the mobile application with login credentials. I re-prioritized the work, removed the blocker, and allowed me to continue the mobile testing, as it taught me to stay flexible and pay attention to dependencies instead of following my original plan with circumstances changed.

[05:23 PM ET] AI Interviewer: Thank you very much. That brings us to the end of the interview. Your responses will now be scored as part of your career programme. Best of luck, and well done for completing it.